

Workflow engine — define a new cycle live

WHAT IT IS

Every cycle you've watched — admissions, milestones, suspension, thesis, corrections, completion — is a definition on the same generic engine. Not code. Data. In this chapter we create a new workflow definition end-to-end (e.g. "Ethics approval") — states, transitions, actions on transition — save it, activate it, then start an instance and drive it through. Adding a new cycle to the platform doesn't need a deploy.

THE CLICKS

01 Open Workflows

WHERE Sidebar → **Workflows** (under ADMINISTRATION).

DO Show the list. Point at existing definitions (Onboarding, Milestone, Thesis, Correction).

SEE Rows: key, name, active toggle, version, instances count.

SAY *“Every cycle we've watched is one row here. The engine doesn't know what a milestone is — it moves state.”*

02 Create a new definition

WHERE Top-right → + **New workflow**.

DO Fill: key `ethics_approval`, name `Ethics approval`, `initial_state` `submitted`, version 1.

SEE Form drawer with sections for states, transitions, and actions.

SAY *“I'm going to add a whole new cycle in three minutes. No deploy.”*

03 Define the states

WHERE **States** section.

DO Add rows: `submitted`, `under_review`, `approved`, `rejected`, `needs_amendment`.

SEE Five state pills.

SAY *“Five states. Nothing fancy. The vocabulary is the ethics committee's own.”*

04 Define the transitions

WHERE Transitions section → + Add transition.

DO Add rows:

from submitted → on assign → to under_review → action createTask (assignee_role: Ethics Reviewer)

from under_review → on approve → to approved → action notify (person: applicant)

from under_review → on reject → to rejected → action notify

from under_review → on request_amendment → to needs_amendment → action createTask (assignee: applicant)

from needs_amendment → on resubmit → to submitted

SEE Transitions listed with from/on/to/action cells.

SAY *“Every transition can fire actions. Tasks land in inboxes, notifications reach the right people. All out of the box.”*

05 Save and activate

WHERE Bottom → **Save**, then toggle **Active**.

DO Click both.

SEE Definition appears in the list with a green "Active" pill and version 1.

SAY *“Live. Any part of the system can now start an ethics_approval instance.”*

THE LINE

“Adding a new cycle isn't a code change — it's a definition, data-driven, versioned.”